10th Class English • Unit 8 • Punjab Board (New Syllabus 2026)

Pollution-free Pakistan with Greenery all Around

Fully solved exercises: comprehension, MCQs, glossary, guided reading response, punctuation and capitals, collaborative discussion, claim–reasoning–evidence writing

A. The Essay at a Glance

Type: a persuasive / argumentative essay with informative paragraphs. **Tone:** serious, concerned and hopeful. **Organisation:** problem (pollution) → causes → solutions (greenery, awareness, laws, community, technology, media) → examples of progress → call to action.

Central idea: a pollution-free Pakistan with greenery all around is not a dream but a necessity, and it is within our reach if individuals, families, schools, communities, the media and the government all act together.

Part of the essay	What it says
Definition	Pollution = harmful substances in the environment that damage air, water and land: vehicle and factory smoke, plastic and chemicals in rivers, and deforestation.
Causes	Rapid urbanisation and industrial growth, factories that do not follow waste-management rules, and the rising number of vehicles on the roads.
Effects on health	Asthma, skin infections and even heart problems, especially among children and the elderly.
Greenery	Trees absorb carbon dioxide and release oxygen, trap dust, reduce heat and support biodiversity; parks and green belts beautify cities and give people a place to relax.
Awareness and education	People must know that daily choices matter — recycle, reuse, reduce; schools must teach environmental protection and run plantation and clean-up campaigns.
Policy and planning	Strict enforcement of environmental laws, accountability of polluters, renewable energy (solar and wind) and better public transport.
Community and technology	“Green Day” and “Clean Street Campaigns”, eco-friendly products, mobile apps to report illegal dumping, smart waste management.
Media	Television, newspapers and social media should highlight success stories and solutions, not only problems.
Proof of progress	Tree plantation drives in Islamabad, rooftop gardens in some schools and youth clean-up drives in parks and along riversides.

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B. Questions Given Beside the Text

1. What is pollution, and how does it affect air, water and land?

Pollution is the presence of harmful substances in our environment. In **air**, smoke from vehicles and factories makes the air dangerous to breathe; in **water**, plastic waste and chemicals dumped into rivers poison the water; on **land**, the cutting of trees and deforestation spoil the soil and reduce greenery. The result is disease — asthma, skin infections and even heart problems — especially among children and the elderly.

2. How can public awareness and education help protect the environment?

Awareness changes the small daily choices that cause most pollution: people stop burning garbage, carry cloth bags instead of plastic ones, and recycle, reuse and reduce waste. Education does this work best through the young, because schools can teach environmental protection and involve students in tree plantation and clean-up campaigns, so that a child's new habit changes a whole household and the student grows into a responsible citizen.

3. How can media help create awareness about a pollution-free environment?

Television, newspapers and social media can spread the message to millions in a single day. They can highlight success stories, show documentaries on how pollution damages health and climate, and explain the solutions instead of only the problems. When the media reports both the danger and the remedy, people feel able to act instead of helpless. Media must therefore be used “as a tool for awareness and change”.

C. Reading Comprehension — Answer the following questions

1. What are the main causes of pollution in Pakistan, and how do they affect human health and the environment?

Causes: (i) smoke from vehicles and factories that pollutes the air; (ii) plastic waste and chemicals dumped into rivers, which pollute water; (iii) cutting of trees and deforestation, which increases land pollution and reduces greenery; (iv) rapid urbanisation and industrial growth, as many factories do not follow proper waste-management rules; and (v) the ever-increasing number of vehicles on the roads.

Effects: on **health**, polluted air and water cause asthma, skin infections, heart problems and other diseases, and children and the elderly suffer most. On the **environment**, the air becomes dangerous to breathe, rivers are poisoned, soil is damaged for the long term, biodiversity falls and the heat of the cities increases because the trees are gone.

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2. How does greenery help reduce pollution and improve the quality of life in cities?

Trees and plants **absorb carbon dioxide and release oxygen**, which is essential for human life, so they clean the air we breathe. They also **trap dust**, **reduce heat** and **support biodiversity**, so cities become cooler and healthier. Parks and green belts beautify the surroundings and give people peaceful places to relax and exercise, which improves both physical and mental health. This is why planting more trees and protecting forests is called one of the most effective ways to fight pollution.

3. Explain how public awareness and education in schools can play a role in building a cleaner and greener Pakistan.

Many people pollute not out of cruelty but out of habit and ignorance: they burn garbage because it is quick, and use plastic bags because they are cheap. Awareness shows them that these small choices have large results, and that recycling, reusing and reducing waste costs nothing. Schools are the best place for this lesson because children learn faster than adults and carry the habit home. When schools teach environmental protection and take students to tree plantation and clean-up campaigns, the students become responsible citizens who care for their surroundings, and in ten years those students are the parents, workers and leaders of the country.

4. What actions can individuals and families take in their daily lives to contribute to a pollution-free environment?

A family can keep its house and street clean, separate wet and dry waste, recycle paper, glass and metal, and refuse single-use plastic bags in favour of cloth bags. It can save electricity by switching off extra lights and fans, save water, use public transport or share a car, avoid burning garbage and leaves, use eco-friendly cleaning products and plant at least one tree in the courtyard or outside the gate. Even small acts — picking up litter, watering a sapling, reporting illegal dumping on an app — count, because the essay reminds us that “every small action does count”.

5. Why is it important to improve public transport systems, and how does this help reduce air pollution?

Most of the smoke in our cities comes from private cars, motorcycles and old buses, because every vehicle burns fuel and releases harmful gases. A good public transport system — buses, metro buses and trains — carries a hundred people in the space and fuel of a few cars, so the same journeys produce far less smoke. When buses are cheap, clean and punctual, people leave their cars at home, the number of vehicles on the road falls, traffic jams shorten and less fuel is burnt while standing still. Improving public transport is therefore one of the cheapest and quickest ways to clean the air of a city.

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6. What are some examples from the essay that show successful environmental efforts already happening in Pakistan?

The essay gives three clear examples. In **Islamabad**, tree plantation drives have increased the green areas of the capital. In **some schools**, students have started **rooftop gardens**. And **youth groups** have organised **clean-up drives** in parks and along the riversides. The essay also mentions community activities such as "Green Day" and "Clean Street Campaigns". These examples prove that change is possible when people work together.

7. How can communities come together to protect the environment, and what activities can they organise?

A community can begin with a small committee of neighbours, a shopkeeper, the imam of the mosque and the school teacher, and then divide the work. It can organise a **"Green Day"** for plantation, a **"Clean Street Campaign"** once a month, a **clean-up drive** in the local park or along the river, a **recycling point** where paper and plastic are collected, and an **awareness walk or poster** campaign in the market. It can also invite the local organisation or shopkeeper to sponsor dustbins and trees. When a whole street acts together, one person's good habit becomes everyone's normal behaviour.

8. What role does the use of renewable energy sources like solar and wind play in reducing pollution?

Renewable sources produce electricity from sunlight and wind instead of burning coal, oil or gas, so they release no smoke and no carbon dioxide. Every unit of solar or wind power that replaces a unit from a coal or oil power station means less harmful gas in the air, less acid rain and a slower rise in temperature. They are also unlimited, so they reduce our dependence on imported fuel, and a rooftop solar panel can light a house even during a power cut. For Pakistan, with long sunny days and strong coastal winds, renewable energy is both clean and practical.

9. Summarise the main message of the essay in your own words and explain why it is important for future generations.

Message: pollution is one of the most serious challenges facing Pakistan, but it is not a curse from nature — it is the result of human habits and weak rules. If we plant trees, reduce waste, enforce environmental laws, use renewable energy and public transport, and educate every child, we can build a cleaner and greener Pakistan, because "every small action does count".

Importance for future generations: the environment we damage today is the environment our children will inherit. Polluted air, poisoned water and vanished forests cannot be bought back with money once they are lost; a child born with asthma in a treeless city has lost something that no development project can return. Acting now is therefore not a favour to the planet but a duty to those who are not yet born — and it is also an Islamic duty, because man is the caretaker, not the owner, of the earth.

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D. Choose the Correct Option (MCQs) — solved with key

1. What is the main cause of air pollution in cities?

tree cutting
river flooding
vehicle smoke
filthy parks

Answer: vehicle smoke — The essay names smoke from vehicles and factories before anything else.

2. What do trees release that benefits humans?

food
fresh oxygen
mineral oil
scent

Answer: fresh oxygen — Trees absorb carbon dioxide and release oxygen, which is essential for life.

3. What can reduce the use of private cars?

plastic recycling
public transport
road repairs
factory closure

Answer: public transport — Good public transport encourages people to leave their cars at home.

4. What helps reduce plastic waste at home?

cloth bags
oil burning
plastic burning
tin utensils

Answer: cloth bags — Replacing plastic bags with cloth bags is the standard reduce-and-reuse step (burning plastic pollutes the air).

5. Which energy sources are safer for the environment?

coal fire
petrol
wind and solar
diesel

Answer: wind and solar — Renewable sources release no smoke or carbon dioxide.

6. How can schools raise environmental awareness?

seminars and awareness programmes
group discussion only
tree campaigns only
posters only

Answer: seminars and awareness programmes — The essay says schools should teach environmental protection and involve students in plantation and clean-up campaigns; a seminar covers all of these.

7. What do communities need for clean surroundings?

mutual efforts
plantation
water tanks
awareness

Answer: mutual efforts — The essay's point is that “when communities work together, great results can be achieved”.

8. What can media do to support the environment?

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spread fear
raise public opinion
talk shows only
share solutions

Answer: raise public opinion — Media must be “a tool for awareness and change” and shape public opinion in favour of a clean environment.

E. Glossary — Words and Meanings

Word	Meaning
biodiversity	the variety of different plants, animals and other living things in a place
deforestation	the cutting down or removal of many trees from an area, usually leading to damage to the environment
garbage	waste or unwanted things that people throw away, like food wrappers, plastic and broken items
healthier	in better physical or mental condition; good for your body and mind
ignores	pays no attention to something or acts like it does not exist
illegal	not allowed by law; against the rules set by a country
immediate	happening right away or without any delay
necessity	something that is needed or very important to have

F. Reading to Analyse — Guided Response Tasks

1. What message did the writer want to share, and how did language make you feel or think in a certain way? Do you personally agree?

Message: a pollution-free Pakistan with greenery all around is not a dream but a necessity, and it is achievable if every person, family, community and institution does its small part.

How language creates the effect: the writer uses **connectors of addition** — “Moreover”, “Furthermore”, “In addition”, “Equally important” — so the argument grows like a staircase and the reader feels that the case is complete. He uses **rhetorical questions** (“What is pollution, and how does it affect air, water, and land?”) to make us think, and **concrete details** (“asthma, skin infections, heart problems”, “children and the elders”) to make the danger personal. The **tone shifts** from alarm to hope — “These examples prove that change is possible” — which is what persuades a reader to act instead of despair.

My response: I agree with the message, because the essay asks nothing costly from me: a cloth bag, a switched-off light, a planted sapling. I do feel one reservation: individual effort alone cannot stop factory smoke, so the essay is right to put law and enforcement beside personal habit. Both together can work; either alone cannot.

2. When reading an argumentative or persuasive essay, what techniques does the writer use to make the point clear and convincing? Give an example from the text and explain its effect.

Four techniques stand out. **(i) Logical order:** definition → causes → solutions, so the reader is never asked to accept a cure before he has seen the disease. **(ii) Examples and evidence:** tree plantation drives in Islamabad, rooftop gardens in schools, youth clean-up drives — these prove that the writer's plan is not theory. **(iii) Contrast:** “if the media only focuses on problems and ignores solutions, the public may feel helpless” — the contrast makes the correct path obvious. **(iv) Direct appeal and emotive language:** “every small action does count” and “not just for ourselves, but for future generations as well”. This last line makes the reader feel responsible rather than accused, and that feeling is what turns a reader into a worker.

3. Choose one type of text (e.g. a biography or a report) on your own. How does the writer structure the information, and what techniques make the message clear? Give an example.

My chosen text: a school report titled “Waste Management at Our School”. **Structure:** it begins with a short **introduction** that states the purpose, then a section on **current practices** (where the dustbins are, how much paper is thrown away), then **findings** with figures, then **suggestions for improvement**, and it ends with a short **conclusion**. **Techniques:** subheadings that let a reader find a section in a second, a table of quantities, and recommendations written with “should”. **Example:** the report says, “The school throws away about 12 kilograms of paper every day, which could be recycled to make roughly 300 notebooks a month.” That single figure with the subheading “Findings” makes the problem credible and the suggestion natural.

4. Read a short passage of your choice. What is one thing the writer states clearly, and one thing you can infer? What evidence helped you?

Passage used (Unit 8): “For example, parks and green belts in cities not only beautify the surroundings but also serve as peaceful places for people to relax and exercise.”

Stated clearly: parks and green belts make a city beautiful and give people a place to relax and exercise.

Inferred: greenery improves people's mental and physical health, and cities with more trees probably have less illness and less street crime, because people are out of doors and busy. **Evidence for the inference:** the words “peaceful places”, “relax” and “exercise” — exercise means health, and a peaceful place means rest for the mind, though the essay never says the word “health” in that sentence.

G. Vocabulary and Grammar — Legibility, Spelling, Punctuation

Legible work means writing clearly and neatly so that others can read it easily, with correct spelling, punctuation (full stops, commas, question marks) and capitalization (the first letter of a sentence and of proper nouns).

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1. Rewrite the sentence using correct spelling, punctuation and capitalization: “my friend alex lives in toronto he likes to read books about history”

My friend Alex lives in Toronto. He likes to read books about history.

Error in the given sentence	Correction and reason	
my friend	My friend	The first word of a sentence begins with a capital letter.
alex	Alex	A person's name is a proper noun and takes a capital.
toronto	Toronto	The name of a city is a proper noun and takes a capital.
no full stop after “toronto”	Toronto. He likes	Two separate sentences need a full stop between them.
he likes	He likes	The first word of the second sentence also takes a capital.

2. Correct the following for practice: “i went to london last summer it was amazing”

I went to London last summer. It was amazing.

H. Oral Communication Skills — Collaborative Discussion

What good discussion looks like (from the model dialogue): the teacher gives a turn instead of letting one student dominate; Saima starts with a clear opinion; Jamal **agrees and adds** (“I agree with Saima, and I'd add…”); Sofia **builds on** Jamal's point and proposes a new question; Saima answers it with an example. So the three moves of a good discussion are: **agree and add**, **build on the last speaker**, and **ask a question that moves the talk forward**.

1. What did each student in the conversation do to help the discussion go well? How could you use one of those strategies in your next group discussion?

Saima opened with a clear opinion and an example (staying connected with family far away). **Jamal** agreed with her before adding a point of his own, and then added a caution ("information isn't always reliable"). **Sofia** accepted his point ("That's a good point") and turned it into a new question about trustworthy sources. **Saima** answered that question with a practical test. In my next discussion I will use Jamal's strategy first — **agree before I disagree** — because it keeps the group friendly, and then add one new point or one new question so that the talk moves forward instead of repeating.

Model dialogue: how individuals and communities can reduce pollution

[A classroom. Five students sit in a circle. The teacher sits outside the circle with a notebook.]

TEACHER: Our question today is simple: how can individuals and communities work together to reduce pollution? Hina, begin please.

HINA: I think it starts at home. My mother has stopped using plastic bags altogether; we carry two cloth bags in the car.

BILAL: I agree with Hina, and I would add one thing: our street burns its garbage every evening, and that smoke is worse than any bag. Could we not ask the waste collector to come twice a week?

AYESHA: That's a good point, Bilal. Building on it, I think the community needs one organised day — a "Clean Street Campaign" — when everybody comes out with bags and brooms together.

USMAN: May I add a question? Who will take responsibility after the campaign day is over? A clean street becomes dirty again in two weeks if nobody is in charge.

HINA: Then each house could take one week of the month — a roster, like the one we use for the school library.

TEACHER: Excellent. You are building on each other's ideas and asking questions that matter. Bilal, will you write our three decisions on the board — cloth bags, weekly garbage, and a street roster?

BILAL: Happily, sir. And I will add a fourth: we plant one tree for every ten houses in the mohallah this spring.

I. Writing Skills — Claim, Reasoning and Evidence

Claim = the opinion or idea you want the reader to accept. **Reasoning** = the logical explanation of why the claim is true. **Evidence** = facts, figures, examples or quotations that prove the reasoning. A strong argument has all three, and the evidence must be **relevant** (it must actually support the point) and **sufficient** (there must be enough of it).

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1. What is a claim in an argumentative text?

A claim is the writer's main statement of opinion — the sentence he wants the reader to believe and to act upon. It is not a fact but a position, so it can be argued for or against. In the essay of this unit the claim is: “A pollution-free Pakistan with greenery all around is not beyond our reach.”

2. What makes reasoning valid? Give an example.

Reasoning is valid when the reason given really leads to the claim, without a hidden jump or a false cause. It must be logical (the conclusion follows from the reason), relevant (it is about the same subject) and complete (it does not leave out an obvious objection). **Example:** “Claim: the school should replace plastic water bottles with steel ones. Reason: a steel bottle is refilled for years, while a plastic bottle is thrown away after one use, so hundreds of bottles per student are saved from the landfill. Therefore the change reduces plastic waste.” The reasoning is valid because the conclusion follows directly from the comparison.

3. How can you tell if evidence is relevant and sufficient?

Relevant: ask whether the evidence is about the same point. A figure about ocean plastic is relevant to a claim about plastic bags, but a figure about car engines is not. **Sufficient:** ask whether there is enough of it, from more than one kind of source — a statistic, an example and an expert opinion together are strong; one quotation alone is weak. Also check the quality: a figure from a government report or a research journal is better evidence than one from a random social-media post.

4. Why is it important to support your claim with more than one piece of evidence?

One piece of evidence can be an accident, an exception or a mistake, so a reader can always answer it with a single counter-example. Two or three independent pieces of evidence, of different kinds, close that door: if a statistic, a real example and an expert opinion all point the same way, the claim looks solid. Multiple evidence also shows the reader that you have researched the topic instead of guessing, and that trust is what persuades him.

5. Look at the example argument. What is the claim, the reasoning and the evidence?

Claim: social media has negatively affected how teenagers communicate in real life. **Reasoning:** teenagers spend so much time online that they are losing confidence in face-to-face conversation. **Evidence:** a 2023 study in the Journal of Teen Communication showed that 62% of teens feel nervous when talking to someone in person, especially a stranger.

Notice the shape of a perfect argument paragraph: claim → one reason → one piece of evidence → one closing sentence that links the evidence back to the claim (“This shows that…”).

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Model argument paragraph (same shape, new topic)

Claim: city buses in Pakistan should be free for all students. **Reasoning:** most students travel to school and college in private vans or on motorcycles, and every one of those vehicles adds smoke to the same air that the students themselves must breathe. **Evidence:** a clean-transport study of Lahore found that a single bus replaces about forty motorcycles on the road, and that traffic smoke is one of the main causes of asthma among school-age children. **Closing:** Free student travel would therefore cost the city far less than the medicine and the lost school days that polluted air already costs it.

J. Summary of the Essay

A pollution-free Pakistan with greenery all around is not a dream but a necessity. Pollution is the presence of harmful substances in the environment: vehicle and factory smoke pollute the air, plastic and chemicals pollute rivers, and deforestation damages the land, so children and the elderly suffer from asthma, skin infections and heart problems. Rapid urbanisation, careless factories and too many vehicles have made the problem worse. Greenery is the natural cure, because trees absorb carbon dioxide, release oxygen, trap dust, reduce heat and support biodiversity, and parks give people a peaceful place to relax. Public awareness and school education must teach people to recycle, reuse and reduce, and to join plantation and clean-up campaigns. Strict environmental laws, accountability of polluters, renewable energy such as solar and wind, and better public transport are equally necessary. Communities and families can organise “Green Day” and “Clean Street Campaigns”, technology can help through apps that report illegal dumping, and the media can highlight solutions instead of only problems. Tree plantation drives in Islamabad, rooftop gardens in schools and youth clean-up drives prove that change is already happening. The essay ends with a call to action: every small step counts, and together we can leave a greener and cleaner Pakistan for future generations.

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Points to Remember

• Pollution = harmful substances in air, water and land; causes asthma, skin infections and heart disease.

• Main causes: vehicle and factory smoke, plastic and chemicals in rivers, deforestation, urbanisation, careless waste management.

• Greenery: absorbs CO_2, releases oxygen, traps dust, reduces heat, supports biodiversity.

• Solutions: awareness and education, strict laws, renewable energy (solar and wind), public transport, community campaigns, technology, media.

• Examples of progress: Islamabad plantation drives, school rooftop gardens, youth clean-up drives, "Green Day", "Clean Street Campaigns".

• Glossary: biodiversity, deforestation, garbage, healthier, ignores, illegal, immediate, necessity.

• Argument structure: claim → reasoning → evidence → closing link. Evidence must be relevant and sufficient.

• Good discussion moves: agree and add, build on the last speaker, ask a question that moves the talk forward.

• Punctuation and capitals: first word of a sentence, proper nouns (Alex, Toronto), full stop between two sentences.

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